

Advertisement

AI



Google is testing a vibe-coding app called Opal

◆ Generate

AI-powered coding tools have become so popular over the past few months that almost every major tech company is either using one or making its own. Makers of these so-called “vibe-coding” tools are a hot commodity at the moment, with startups like [Lovable](#) and [Cursor](#) fending off buyers and investors keen to tap a hot trend.

Google’s now become the latest to hop on this bandwagon: The company is testing a vibe-coding tool called [Opal](#), available to users in the U.S. through Google Labs, which the company uses as a base to experiment with new tech.

Opal lets you create mini web apps using text prompts, or you can remix existing apps available in a gallery. All users have to do is enter a description of the app they want to make, and the tool will then use different Google models to do so.

IMAGE CREDITS: GOOGLE



Once the app is ready, you can navigate into an editor panel to see the visual workflow of input,

TECH DISRUPT

October 27-29, 2025 | San Francisco

Put your brand in front of 10,000+ tech and VC leaders across all three days of Disrupt 2025. Amplify your reach, spark real connections, and lead the innovation charge. Secure your exhibit space before your competitor does.

[Book Your Table >](#)

Most Popular



- Key sections of the US Constitution deleted from government’s website
- Three weeks after acquiring Windsurf, Cognition offers staff the exit door
- Roku launches Howdy, a \$2.99 ad-free streaming service
- Spotify raises subscription prices
- The uproar over Vogue’s AI-generated ad isn’t just about fashion

output, and generation steps. You can click on each workflow step to look at the prompt that dictates the process, and edit it if you need to. You also can manually add steps from Opal's toolbar.

Opal also lets users publish their new app on the web and share the link with others to test out using their own Google accounts.

Google's [AI studio](#) already lets developers build apps using prompts, but Opal's visual workflow indicates the company likely wants to target a wider audience.

The company joins a long list of competitors, including [Canva](#), [Figma](#), and Replit, that are making tools to encourage non-technical people to create prototypes of apps without having to do any coding.

- Your public ChatGPT queries are getting indexed by Google and other search engines
- The best dating apps aren't even dating apps

TC

Tech and VC heavyweights join the Disrupt 2025 agenda

Netflix, ElevenLabs, Wayve, Sequoia Capital — just a few of the heavy hitters joining the Disrupt 2025 agenda. They're here to deliver the insights that fuel startup growth and sharpen your edge. Don't miss the 20th anniversary of TechCrunch Disrupt, and a chance to learn from the top voices in tech — grab your ticket now and save up to \$675 before prices rise on August 7.

San Francisco | October 27-29, 2025

REGISTER NOW

Topics: [AI](#) [ai apps](#) [Apps](#) [Google](#) [google labs](#)

[vibe coding](#).



Ivan Mehta

[X](#)
[in](#)

Ivan covers global consumer tech developments at TechCrunch. He is based out of India and has previously...

View Bio >

KEEP READING



AI

Adobe releases new Firefly image generation models and a redesigned Firefly web app

Ivan Mehta — 2:00 AM PDT · April 24, 2025

IMAGE CREDITS:
 JAQUE SILVA/SOPA IMAGES/LIGHTROCKET / GETTY IMAGES

Adobe on Thursday launched the latest iteration of its Firefly family of image generation AI models, a model for generating vectors, and a [redesigned web app](#) that houses all its AI models, plus some from its competitors. There's also a mobile app for Firefly in the works.

The new Firefly Image Model 4, Adobe says, improves on its predecessors in terms of quality, speed, and the amount of control over the structure and style of outputs, camera angles, and zoom. It can generate images in resolutions up to 2K. There's also a tweaked, more capable version of this model called Image Model 4 Ultra that can render complex scenes consisting of small structures and lots of detail.

Alexandru Costin, VP of Generative AI at Adobe, said that the company trained the models with a higher order of compute magnitude to enable them to generate more detailed images. He added that, as compared to previous generation models, the new models improve text generation in images and have features that let users use images of their choice to get the model to generate pictures in that style.

The company is also making its Firefly video model, which [launched in limited beta last year](#), available to everyone. It lets users generate video clips from a text prompt or image, use camera angles, specify start and end frames to control shots, generate atmospheric elements, and customize motion design elements. The model can generate video clips from text at resolutions up to 1080p.

Meanwhile, the Firefly Vector Model can create editable vector-based artwork, iterate and generate variations of logos, product packaging, icons, scenes, and patterns.

Notably, Firefly’s web app gives you access to all these models as well as a few image and video generation models from OpenAI (GPT image generation), Google (Imagen 3 and Veo 2), and Flux (Flux 1.1 Pro). Users can switch between any of these models at any point, and images generated from any model will have content credentials attached to them. The company hinted that other AI models may be added to the web app in the future.

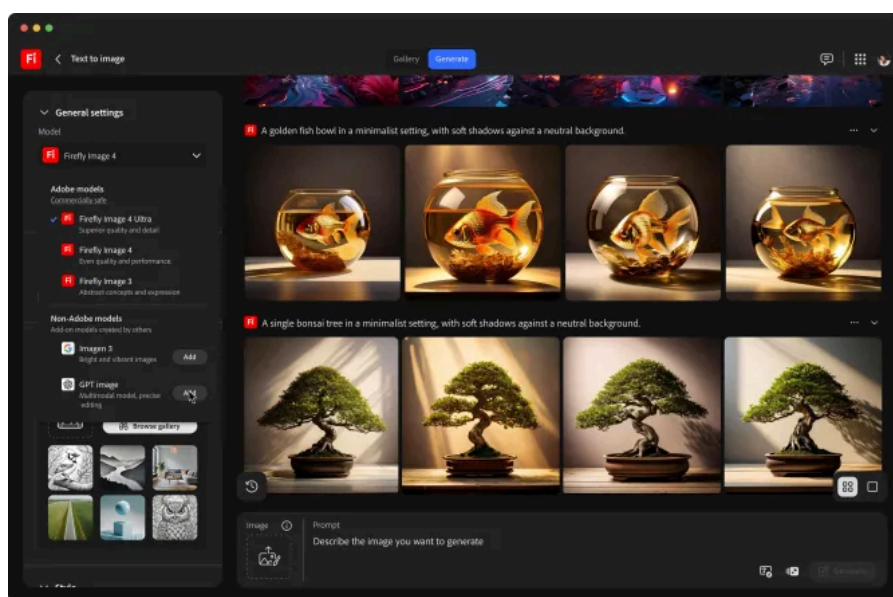


IMAGE CREDITS: ADOBE

Adobe is also publicly testing a new product called Firefly Boards, a canvas for ideation or moodboarding. It lets users generate or import images, remix them, and collaborate with others — similar to what you can do with other AI-based ideaboards from [Visual Electric](#), [Cove](#), or [Kosmik](#). Boards is available through the Firefly web app.



Tech and VC heavyweights join the Disrupt 2025 agenda

Netflix, ElevenLabs, Wayve, Sequoia Capital — just a few of the heavy hitters joining the Disrupt 2025 agenda. They’re here to deliver the insights that fuel startup growth and sharpen your edge. Don’t miss the 20th anniversary of TechCrunch Disrupt, and a chance to learn from

Advertisement

Newsletters

[See More ↗](#)

Subscribe for the industry’s biggest tech news

TechCrunch Daily News



Every weekday and Sunday, you can get the best of TechCrunch’s coverage.

Startups Weekly



Startups are the core of TechCrunch, so get our best coverage delivered weekly.

TechCrunch Week in Review



Get the best of our coverage, delivered to your inbox every Saturday.

TechCrunch Mobility



TechCrunch Mobility is your destination for transportation news and insight.

No newsletters selected.

Email address

Subscribe

By submitting your email, you agree to our [Terms](#) and [Privacy Notice](#).

the top voices in tech — grab your ticket now and save up to \$675 before prices rise on August 7.

San Francisco | October 27-29, 2025

REGISTER NOW

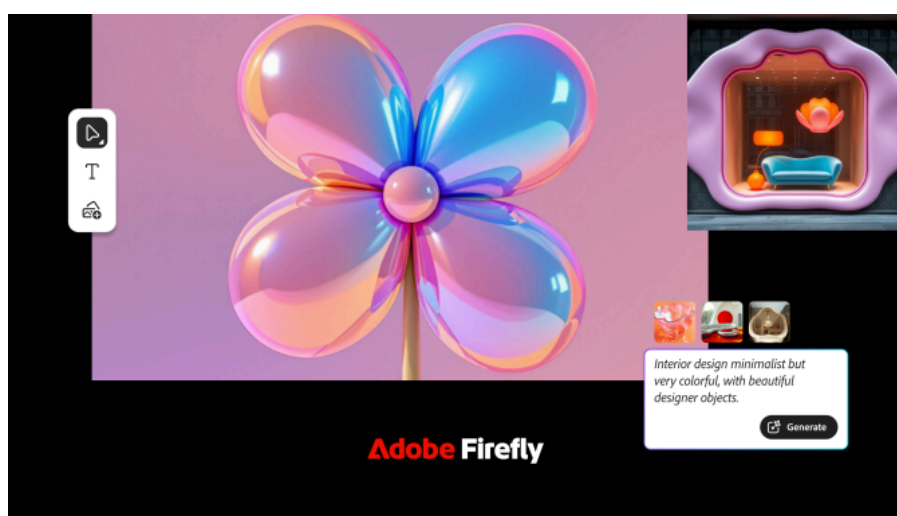


IMAGE CREDITS: ADOBE

The company said these new models would soon be integrated into its product portfolio, but didn't give a timeline for the rollout.

Adobe is also making its Text-to-Image API and Avatar API generally available, and said a new Text-to-Video API is now available for use in beta. These APIs are available through the company's Firefly Services collection of APIs, tools, and services.

Adobe is also testing a web app called [Adobe Content Authenticity](#) to let users attach credentials to their work to indicate ownership and attribution through metadata. Users can also indicate whether AI companies can use any images for AI model training.

Topics: [Adobe](#) [Adobe Firefly](#) [AI](#) [Creative Cloud](#)



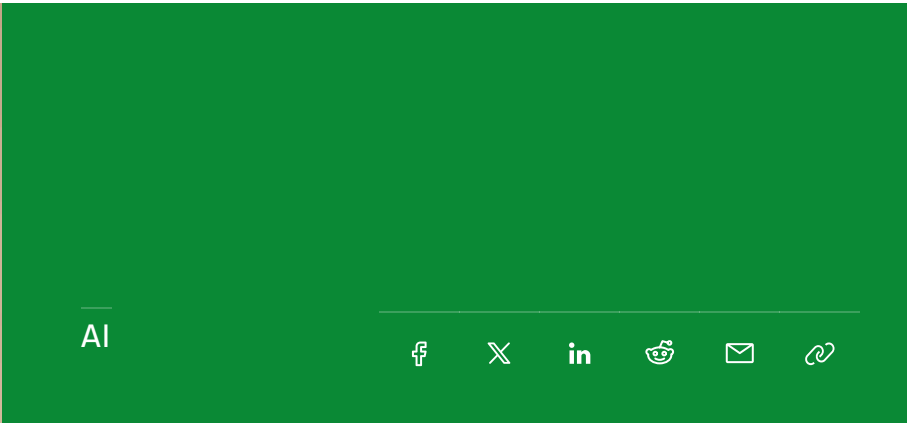
Ivan Mehta

X in

Ivan covers global consumer tech developments at TechCrunch. He is based out of India and has previously...

View Bio >

KEEP READING



AI

- Latest
- Security
- Startups
- AI
- Venture
- Apps
- Apple



- Events
- Podcasts
- Newsletters

IMAGE CREDITS:
GABBY JONES/BLOOMBERG / GETTY IMAGES

Elon Musk’s AI company, xAI, is testing out [a stand-alone iOS app](#) for its chatbot, Grok, which was

available only to X users until now.

The app, currently live in multiple countries, including the U.S., Australia, and India, can access real-time data from the web and X; offers generative AI features like rewriting text, summarizing long paragraphs, a little bit of Q&A; and can [generate images](#) from text prompts.

“Grok is an AI-powered assistant designed to be maximally truthful, useful, and curious. Get answers to any question, generate striking images, and upload pictures to gain a deeper understanding of your world,” the listing reads.

xAI is also preparing a dedicated site, Grok.com, to make the chatbot accessible on the web. Currently, the site says “coming soon” when you log in with an xAI account.

Grok was available only to X’s paying subscribers until recently. In November, the company [started testing a free version of the chatbot](#) and rolled it out to [all users earlier this month](#).

The company says its chatbot’s image generator model excels at “photorealistic rendering” and doesn’t apply major restrictions on its image-generation capabilities, allowing users to create images using pictures of public figures and copyrighted material.

The story has been updated to reflect that the Grok app has launched in multiple countries in beta.

Latest in AI

See More

AI



Google denies AI search features are killing website traffic

Sarah Perez - 11 hours ago

AI



First impressions of Alexa+, Amazon’s upgraded, AI-powered digital assistant

Sarah Perez - 13 hours ago

AI



Google takes on ChatGPT’s Study Mode with new ‘Guided Learning’ tool in Gemini

Aisha Malik - 13 hours ago

TC

Tech and VC heavyweights join the Disrupt 2025 agenda

Netflix, ElevenLabs, Wayve, Sequoia Capital — just a few of the heavy hitters joining the Disrupt 2025 agenda. They’re here to deliver the

insights that fuel startup growth and sharpen your edge. Don't miss the 20th anniversary of TechCrunch Disrupt, and a chance to learn from the top voices in tech — grab your ticket now and save up to \$675 before prices rise on August 7.

San Francisco | October 27-29, 2025

REGISTER NOW

TechCrunch has an AI-focused newsletter! [Sign up here](#) to get it in your inbox every Wednesday.

Topics: [AI](#) [AI chatbot](#) [Elon Musk](#) [Grok](#) [Twitter](#)

[xAI](#)



Ivan Mehta

[X](#) [in](#)

Ivan covers global consumer tech developments at TechCrunch. He is based out of India and has previously...

View Bio >

KEEP READING



IMAGE CREDITS: LENOVO

AI



Google adds AI features to Chromebook Plus devices

Ivan Mehta — 6:00 AM PDT · June 23, 2025

Google's adding a slew of AI features to its productivity-focused [Chromebook Plus](#) line of devices, including a screen-selection tool for search and text capture, a tool that explains complex text, and NotebookLM.

The new screen-selection tool works similarly to [Google Lens](#) and the "Circle to search" feature in Chrome on [smartphones](#): long-press the launcher button or use the screenshot tool to select what is on your screen, and Google will instantly search for it. The tool also lets you select text and quickly add an event to the calendar.

Advertisement

TC DISRUPT

October 27-29, 2025 | San Francisco

Put your brand in front of 10,000+ tech and VC leaders across all three days of Disrupt 2025. Amplify your reach, spark real connections, and lead the innovation charge. Secure your exhibit space before your competitor does.

[Book Your Table >](#)

IMAGE CREDITS:GOOGLE

Last year, Google added a new [“quick insert” key](#) to some Chromebook Plus models that lets you trigger shortcuts. Users can now access Google’s AI image-generation features with this key, as well as AI-powered writing tools.

Meanwhile, the new “Simplify” feature lets you use AI to explain, simplify, or summarize any text you have selected.

Google’s also giving all new Chromebook Plus users one year’s subscription to the Google AI Pro plan, which includes access to the Gemini app; video editing tool Flow; image-to-video creation tool Whisk; Gemini in Gmail, Docs, and Chrome; and 2TB of storage. The AI Pro plan otherwise costs \$240 per year.

Alongside these features, Google is launching two exclusive AI features for Lenovo’s new Chromebook Plus 14: One uses AI to recommend tab and document organization, while the second lets users edit images using the Gallery app to remove backgrounds or make stickers.

Lenovo’s new Chromebook comes with an OLED touch screen and runs on an ARM-based MediaTek Kompanio Ultra chip. It comes in 12GB and 16GB RAM variants, costing \$649 and \$749, respectively.

Most Popular



- Key sections of the US Constitution deleted from government’s website
- Three weeks after acquiring Windsurf, Cognition offers staff the exit door
- Roku launches Howdy, a \$2.99 ad-free streaming service
- Spotify raises subscription prices
- The uproar over Vogue’s AI-generated ad isn’t just about fashion
- Lina Khan points to Figma IPO as vindication of M&A scrutiny
- Your public ChatGPT queries are getting indexed by Google and other search engines

Advertisement



Tech and VC heavyweights join the Disrupt 2025 agenda

Netflix, ElevenLabs, Wayve, Sequoia Capital — just a few of the heavy hitters joining the Disrupt 2025 agenda. They’re here to deliver the insights that fuel startup growth and sharpen your edge. Don’t miss the 20th anniversary of TechCrunch Disrupt, and a chance to learn from the top voices in tech — grab your ticket now and save up to \$675 before prices rise on August 7.

San Francisco | October 27-29, 2025

REGISTER NOW

Topics: [AI](#) [chromebook plus](#) [Gadgets](#) [Google](#)

[lenovo](#)

Advertisement

[f](#) [X](#) [in](#) [📺](#) [✉](#) [🔗](#)



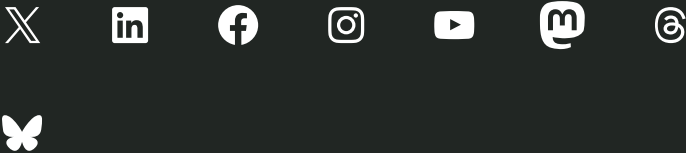
Ivan Mehta

[X](#) [in](#)

Ivan covers global consumer tech developments at TechCrunch. He is based out of India and has previously...

View Bio >

Loading the next article



TechCrunch
Staff

Contact Us

Advertise
Crunchboard
Jobs

Site Map

Terms of
Service

Privacy
Policy

RSS Terms of
Use

OpenAI
Perplexity
Cisco
DeepMind
Windsurf
Tech Layoffs
ChatGPT